

sage propagator. This makes tracking the phish to the original phisher more difficult.

Phishers also transmit a host of malicious content to get valuable private information about individuals. Essentially, these are hacking techniques used by phishers to observe the activities of the users of host computers. This is especially dangerous when the host computer is in a bank, or in a finance firm that deals with large amounts of customer data and large sums of money.

6.2.3.1 Keyloggers

One of the most common spying techniques, a keylogger, as the name suggests, logs the keypresses of the user. Basically, it makes a log of all the keys pressed on the user's keyboard and transmits this log to the phisher.

Actually, keyloggers don't make a log of every single keypress of the user's keyboard: they generally make a log of those keypresses used when the user needs to submit some data for authentication purposes. This could be in terms of passwords, credit card numbers, etc.

6.2.3.2 Screen-grabbing

The more enterprising of phishers capture personal data in the form of screen grabs of the user's desktop. Given that there are already several attempts to block keyloggers by corporations and home users alike, sophisticated phishers find this an effective way of capturing confidential customer/user information. Phishers also don't need a grab of the entire screen for their purposes. In order to keep the upload size of the data small, they only grab the "relevant" sections of the screen wherein there is a disclosure of confidential information.